

Defense Brief

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Pentagon Gives Industry 21 Days to Accelerate Production, Army Opens Test Ranges, Egypt Eyes Mecca Pact

The Bottom Line

The Pentagon's 21-day ultimatum to defense firms and the Army's decision to throw open test ranges to private companies are the day's most consequential defense-industry moves — together they represent an admission that the US acquisition system itself, not just factory floors, is a warfighting bottleneck. Meanwhile, the Mecca Pact is already expanding before the ink dries, with Egypt potentially joining a Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan framework that includes NATO-Article-5-style mutual defense and — more consequentially — technology transfer clauses. Pakistan's simultaneous China-backed build-up along Sir Creek and India's Kusha SAM test show the subcontinent's arms dynamics accelerating on both sides. At 81 years since Nagasaki, the nuclear disarmament framework has arguably never looked weaker.